



清华大学  
Tsinghua University

# General Management 2026 Spring

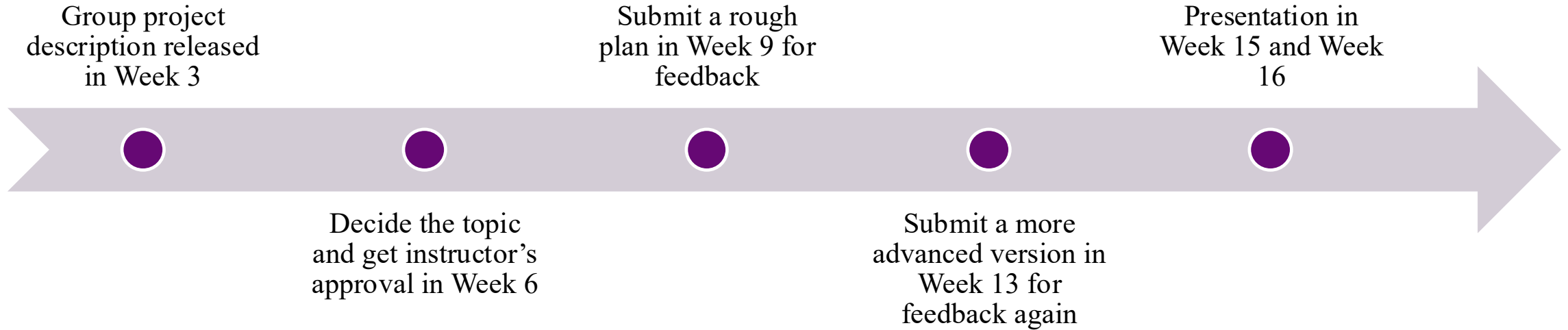
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**Leadership and Organization Management**

**School of Economics and Management**

# Rough Timeline for Group Project



# The Importance of Evidence-Based Thinking



Journal of Personality and Social Psychology:  
Personality Processes and Individual Differences

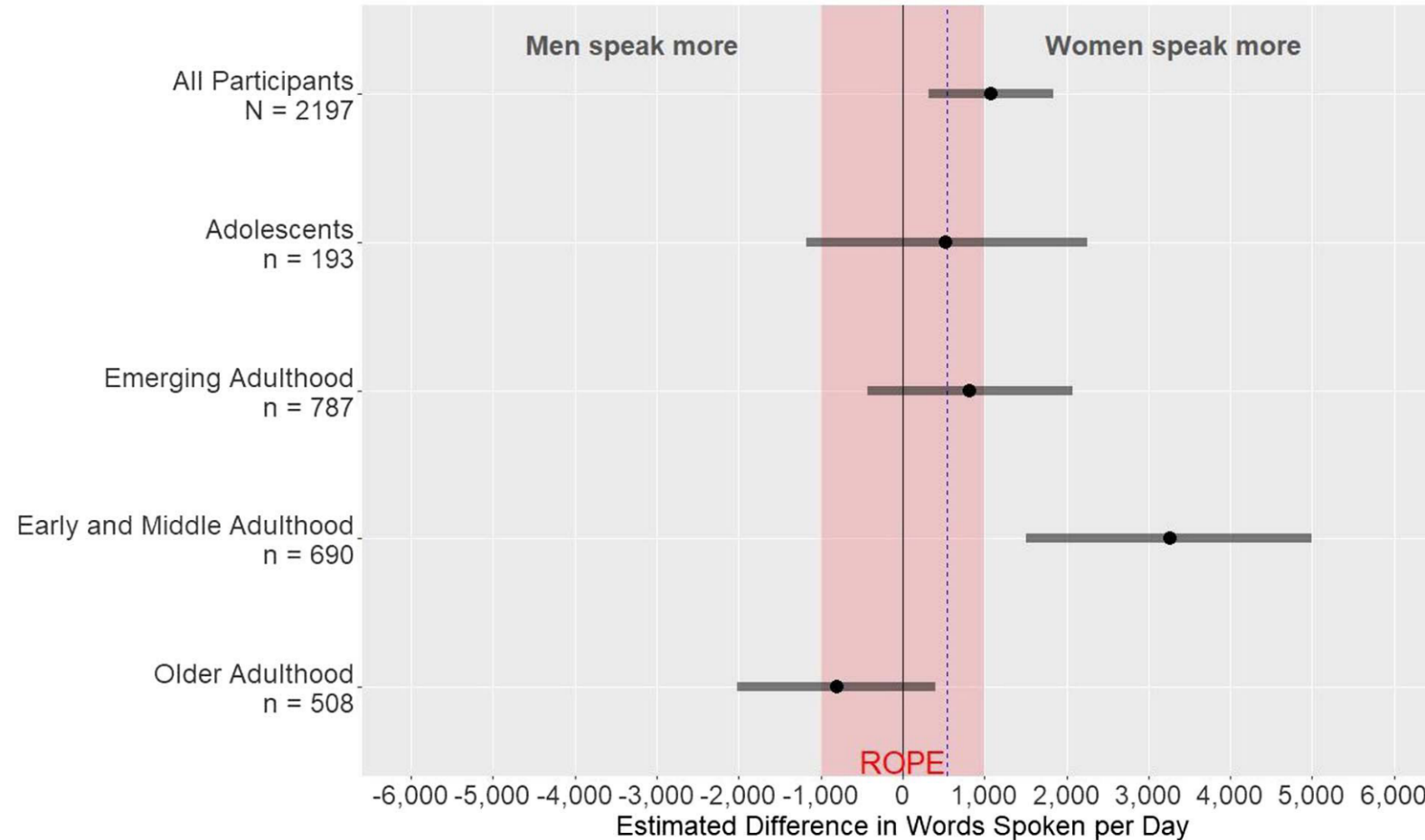
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ISSN: 0022-3514

2025, Vol. 128, No. 2, 367–391  
<https://doi.org/10.1037/pspp0000534>

## Are Women Really (Not) More Talkative Than Men? A Registered Report of Binary Gender Similarities/Differences in Daily Word Use

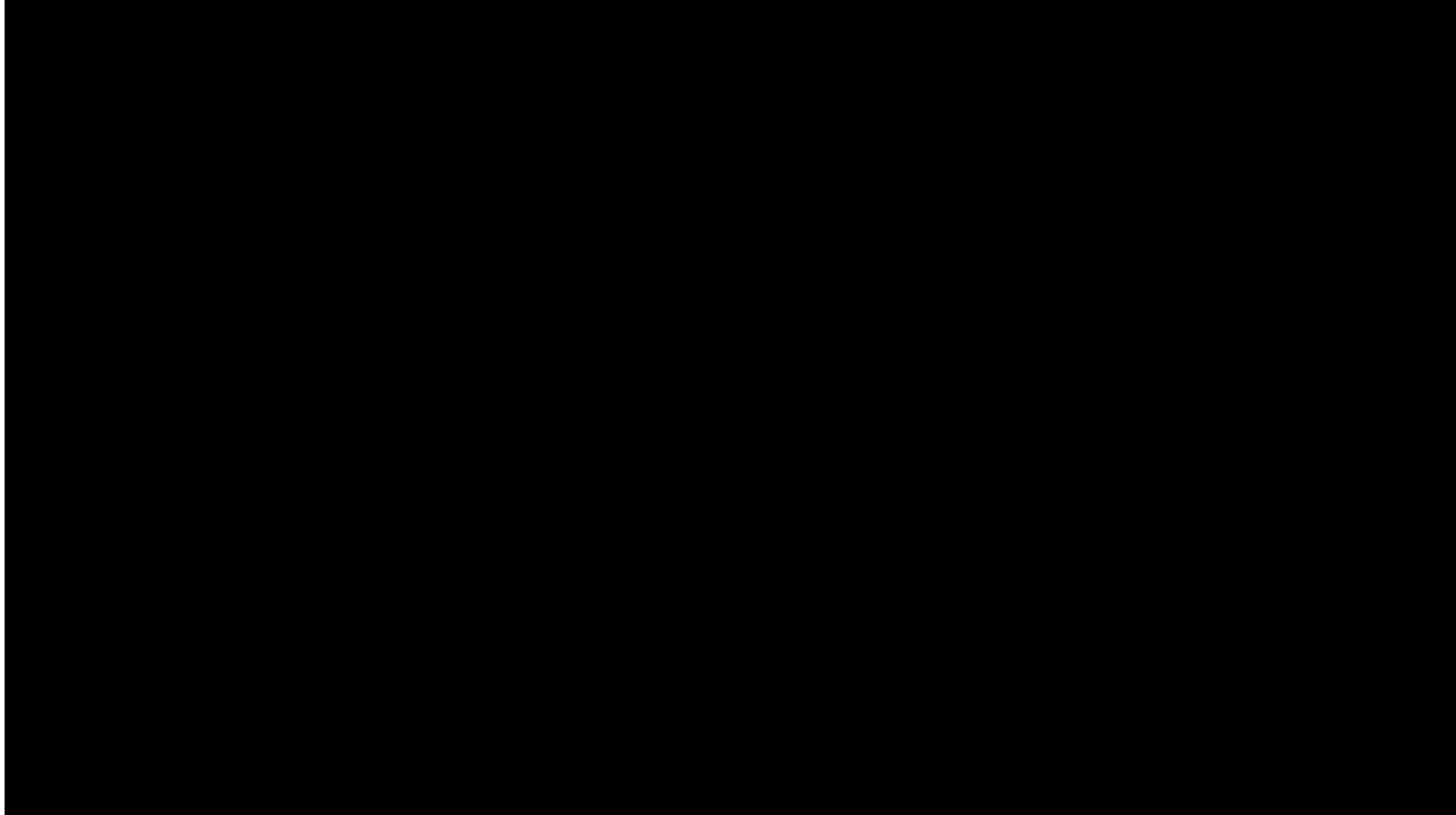
# The Importance of Evidence-Based Thinking

*Estimated Gender Difference in Words Spoken per Day for All Participants and by Age Group*



Across 2,197 participants, pooled over 22 samples (631,030 ambient audio recordings), men spoke on average 11,950 WPD and women 13,349 WPD, with individual differences

# Who Has Heard of The Marshmallow Test



# Individual Differences in Self-Control



- **The Marshmallow Test**
- Child offered a choice between one small reward right away or two small rewards if waited 15 minutes
- **Decades Later**
- Children who were able to delay gratification...
  - Had more educational/professional achievements
  - Were less likely to be obese or in prison

**Some traits are stable across time, even a lifetime!**

- **Personality trait:** the *relatively stable* set of psychological attributes that distinguish one person from another
- **Unified and consistent**
- **Enduring and stable**
- Personality change is seen as something which only occurs as the result of some major life events or the result of some planned interventions like therapy.

# Why is Understanding Personality Important?



**Self-awareness**



**Improves collaboration**



**Predicts performance**



# Why is Understanding Personality Important?

Think about your best friend now

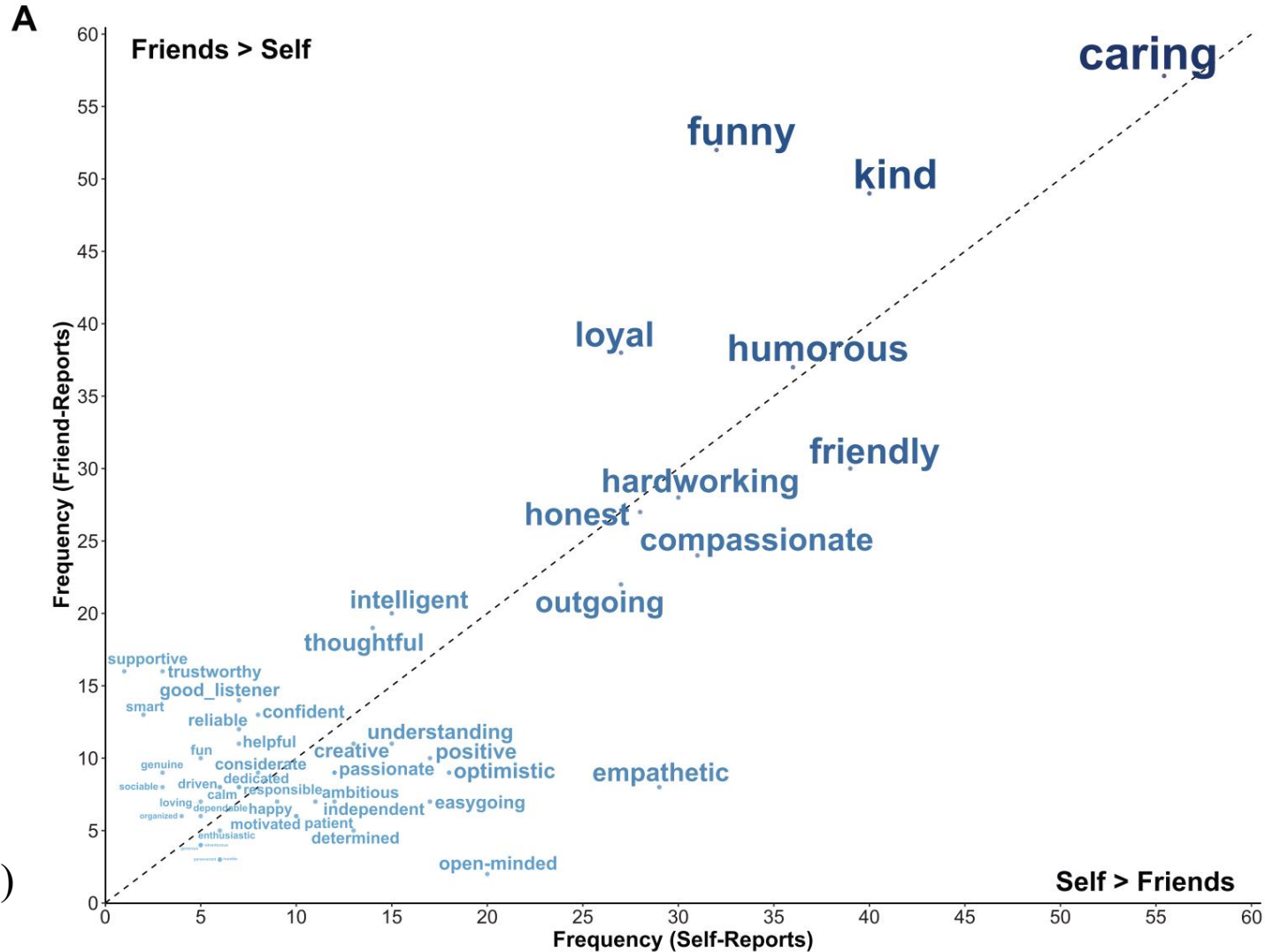
Name two traits that you like MOST about your best friend.





# Why is Understanding Personality Important?

Self and by 2 friends, 2 weeks across 211 three samples



Sun et al. (2022)

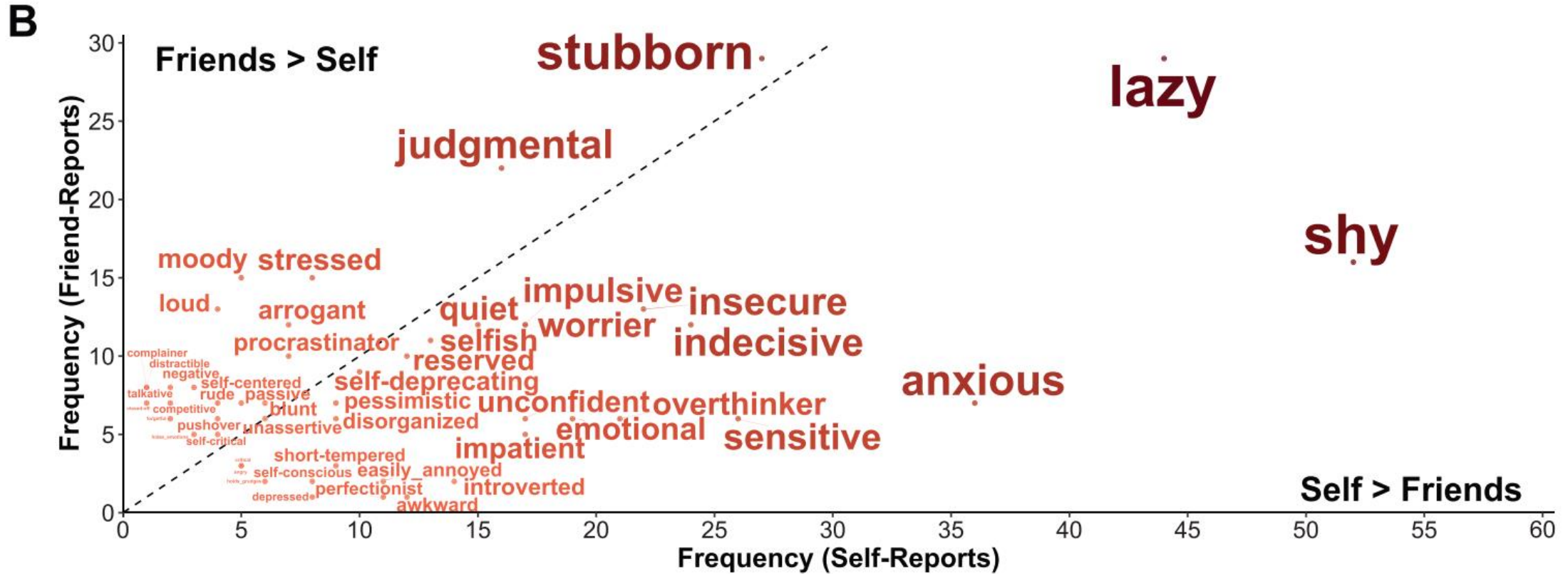
# Why is Understanding Personality Important?

Think about your best friend now

Name two traits that you hate MOST about your best friend.



# Why is Understanding Personality Important?



Sun et al. (2022)



# Myers–Briggs Type Indicator

- Where do we get energy?
  - Introverts vs. extroverts
- How do we take in information?
  - Sensing vs. intuition
- How do we make decisions?
  - Thinking vs. feelings
- How do we organize our world?
  - Judging vs. perceiving

You? Others? Teams? Organizations?

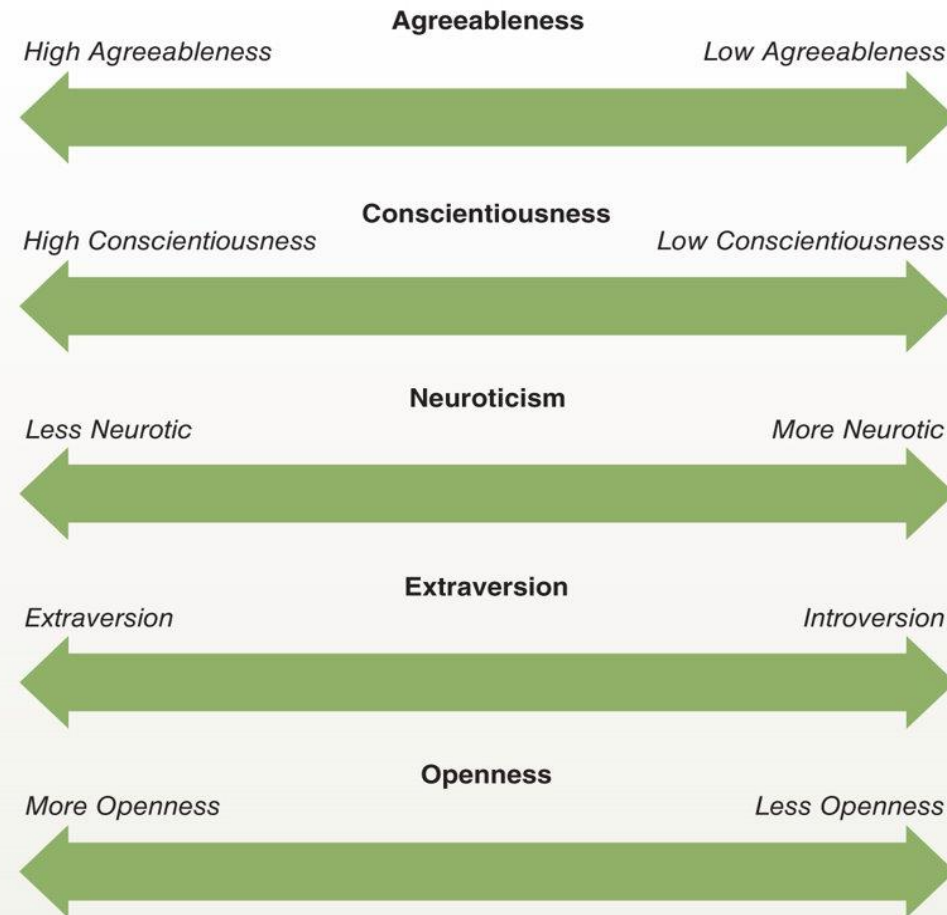
# Big Five



**Figure 3.1**

The “big five” personality framework is currently very popular among researchers and managers. These five dimensions represent fundamental personality traits presumed to be important in determining the behaviors of individuals in organizations. In general, experts agree that personality traits closer to the left end of each dimension are more positive in organizational settings, whereas traits closer to the right are less positive.

## “Big Five” personality traits



# Big Five vs. MBTI

## Matching dimensions

- Conscientiousness → Judging-Perceiving
- Agreeableness → Feeling-Thinking
- Openness → Intuition-Sensing
- Extraversion → Extraversion-Introversion



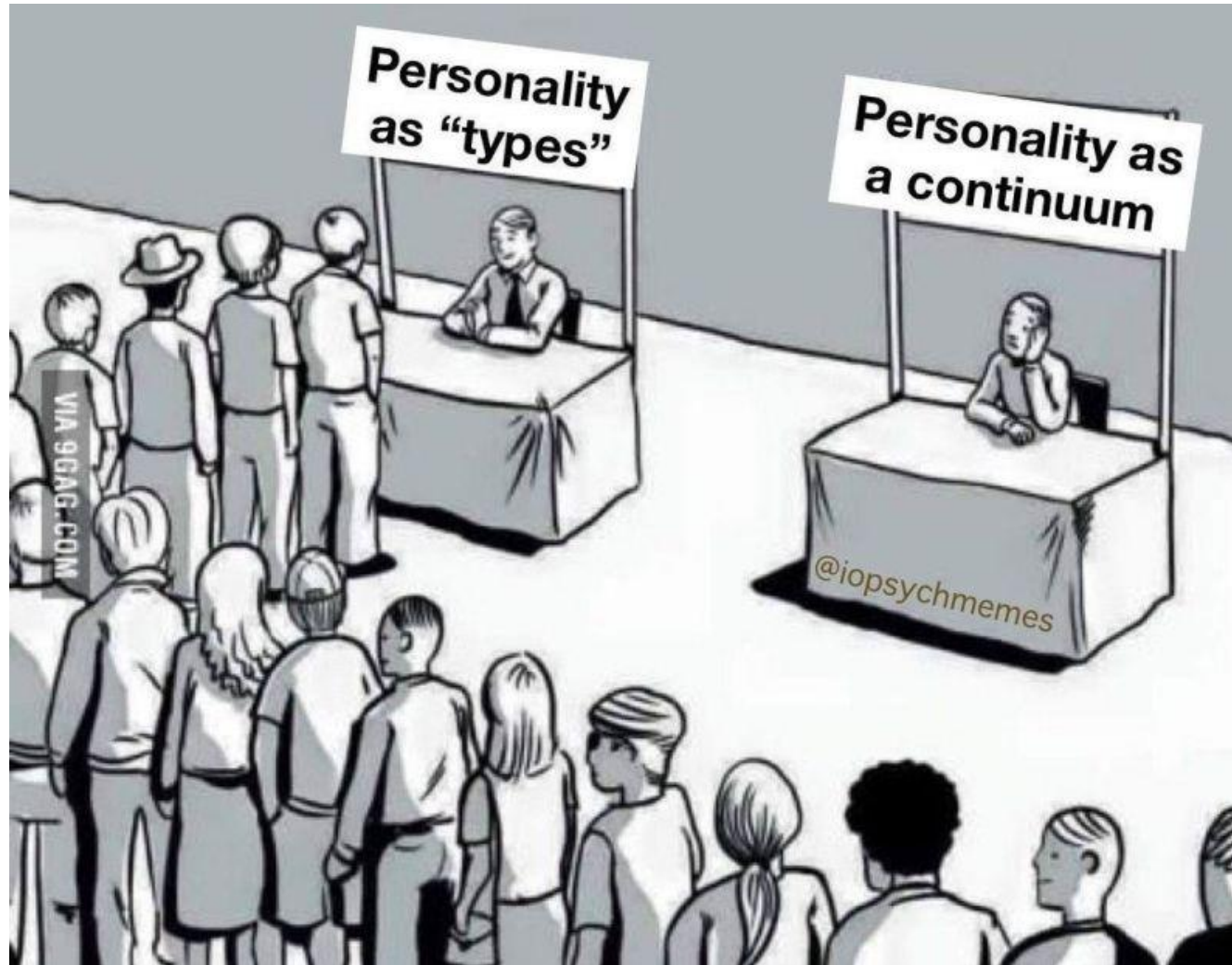
## Why Big 5 is better

- Emotional Reactions / Neuroticism not covered by MBTI
- NEO has better psychometric properties (factor structure, test-retest-reliability)





# Big Five vs. MBTI





# Openness to Experience



*The inclination to be interested in new and/or unusual things.*



## Low scores

- ▶ Down to earth, narrow range of interests, practical/technical
- + Have good grasp of what is happening on day-to-day basis, good project managers
- May not see big picture, fixed ideas about world, too much focused on here and now

## High scores

- ▶ Imaginative, artistic, experimental, curious
- + Creative, enjoy change, tolerant new ideas
- Changes opinion often, doesn't care about procedures, can appear inconsistent

# Openness to Experience



*The inclination to be interested in new and/or unusual things.*



Low scores

Manage yourself when low

- ▶ Involve others to challenge you and help you brainstorm

Manage others who are low

- ▶ Provide them data

High scores

Manage yourself when high

- ▶ Work on plans and practicalities

Manage others who are high

- ▶ Be creative; ready to brainstorm
- ▶ Give big picture first

# Conscientiousness



*Interest in leading a structured and organized life*



## Low scores

- ▶ Spontaneous, flexible, disorganised, careless
- + Responsive to changing needs, easy going, relaxed outlook
- Easily distracted, chaotic and messy (some say less reliable)

## High scores

- ▶ Efficient, organised, strong sense of duty, self-disciplined
- + Reliable, hard worker with high drive, very structured, perfectionist
- Workaholic, can be hard on others, obsessive about control

# Who do these offices belong to?



**Low  
conscientiousness**



**High  
conscientiousness**

# Conscientiousness



*Interest in leading a structured and organized life*



**Low scores**

**Manage yourself when low**

- ▶ Impose structure on yourself  
(e.g., ask others for help)

**Manage others who are low**

- ▶ Provide structure; realize things  
might take longer

**High scores**

**Manage yourself when high**

- ▶ Increase social awareness, step  
back, learn to delegate

**Manage others who are high**

- ▶ Be organized and on time, cover all  
the points, don't waste time

# Extraversion



*The predisposition to get energy from being around others.*



## Low scores

- ▶ Reserved, serious, prefers privacy, perceived as loners
- + Think carefully, they are non-disruptive, effective listeners
- Smaller networks, difficulties motivating others, often misunderstood, perceived as unfriendly

## High scores

- ▶ Outgoing, sociable, talkative, assertive, dominant
- + They are (initially) liked, good networkers, inclusive
- Act before they think, they don't listen, have no time, can bulldoze others, dislike solitary confinement



# Who's High or Low on Extraversion?



**Low extraversion**



**High extraversion**

# COVID-19 Pandemic: High vs. Low Extraversion





# Extraversion



*The predisposition to get energy from being around others.*



Low scores

Manage yourself when low

- ▶ Work on high-level social behavior (“Hi!” goes a long way)

Manage others who are low

- ▶ Give more written feedback, spend more time listening
- ▶ Allow them to work alone

High scores

Manage yourself when high

- ▶ Think twice when you think you have something important to say

Manage others who are high

- ▶ Need to create opportunities for them to listen

# Agreeableness



*The tendency to place high value on getting along with others*



## Low scores

- ▶ Sceptical, tough-minded, competitive, impersonal
- + Thick skinned, outcome- focused, ask tough questions, make difficult decisions
- Alienate others, often get into conflict, foster distrust in others

## High scores

- ▶ Compassionate, co-operative, friendly, tolerant, trusting
- + Good at building relationships, caring, and charitable
- Predictable to others, easily taken for a ride, avoid conflict, can't make difficult decisions

# Agreeableness



*The tendency to place high value on getting along with others*



## Low scores

### Manage yourself when low

- ▶ Get feedback from others
- ▶ Ask questions, actively listen

### Manage others who are low

- ▶ Ask what they think (not feel)
- ▶ Be prepared for disagreement

## High scores

### Manage yourself when high

- ▶ Work on difficult conversations (e.g., role play) or outsource

### Manage others who are high

- ▶ Be prepared to be sensitive, encouraging and positive

# Neuroticism (Emotional Stability)



*The ability to regulate stress and emotion*



## Low scores

- ▶ Calm, patient, even-tempered, self-confident, resilient to stress
- + Always cool, good in crises, stable, get things done, and bounce back from failures
- Perceived as dull, indifferent, insensitive, and unaware of others' feelings

## High scores

- ▶ Anxious, irritable, moody, low self-esteem, sensitive to stress
- + Easy to read their emotions, will not allow team to get complacent, stress-meters
- Stress out everyone else, too nervous, burnout prone, take a lot of time & energy to manage

# Neuroticism (Emotional Stability)



*The ability to regulate stress and emotion*



## Low scores

### Manage yourself when low

- ▶ Get regular feedback from others (you can take it!)

### Manage others who are low

- ▶ Be very direct with feedback (“sledgehammer”)

## High scores

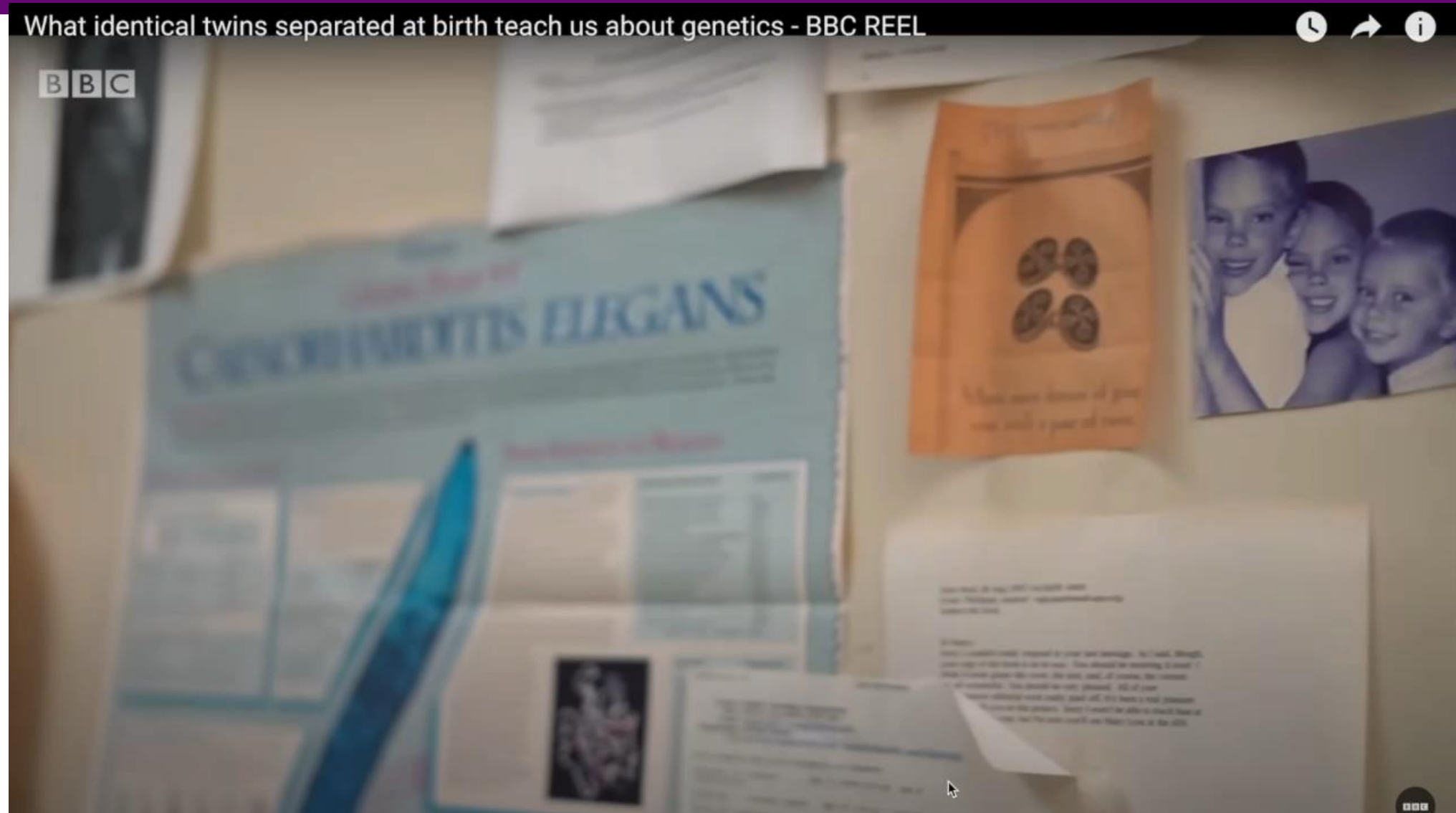
### Manage yourself when high

- ▶ Manage stress
- ▶ Practice getting feedback

### Manage others who are high

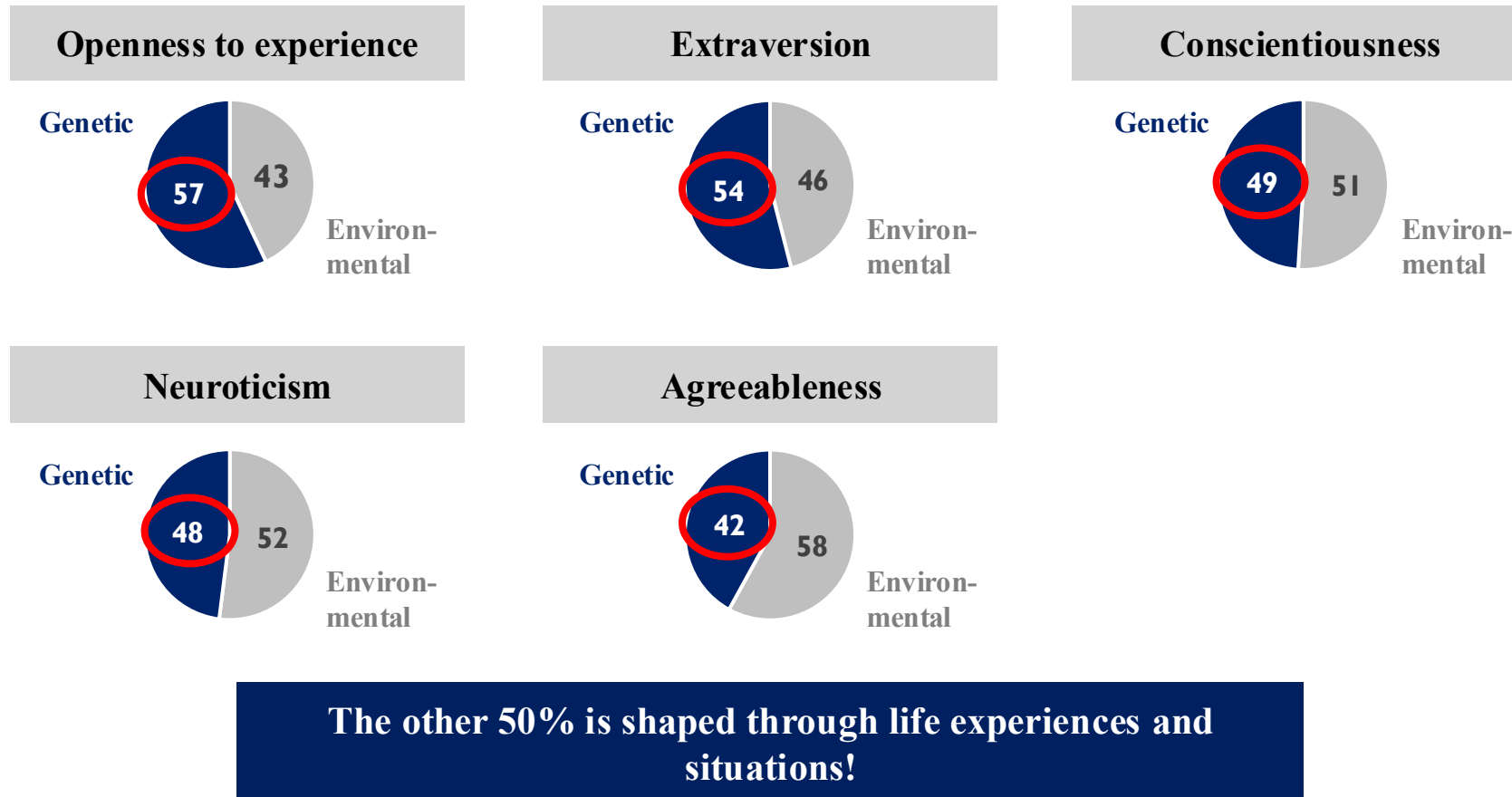
- ▶ Be careful, tailor feedback to their mood

# Personality: Born or Made?





# 50% of Personality is Explained by Genes

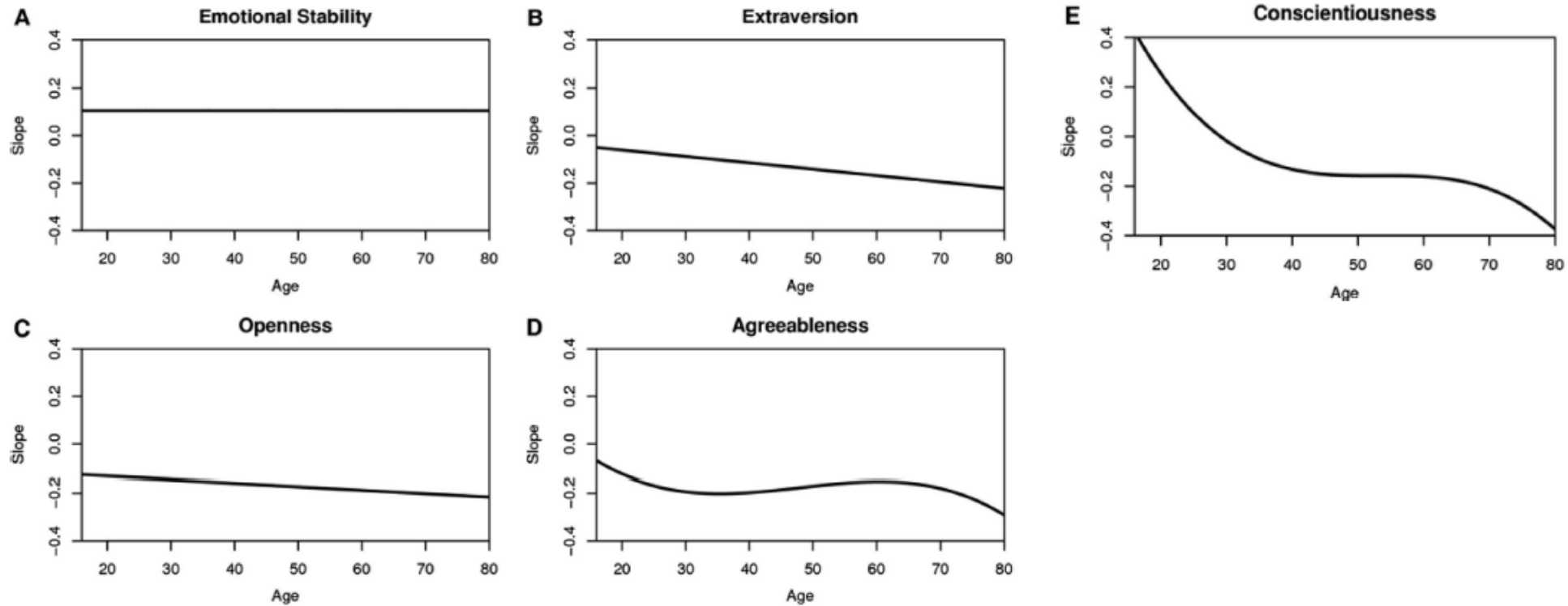


Note: Numbers represent percentages  
Bouchard et al. (2003)

# Personality Changes Over Time



## Changes in personality across lifespan (early findings)

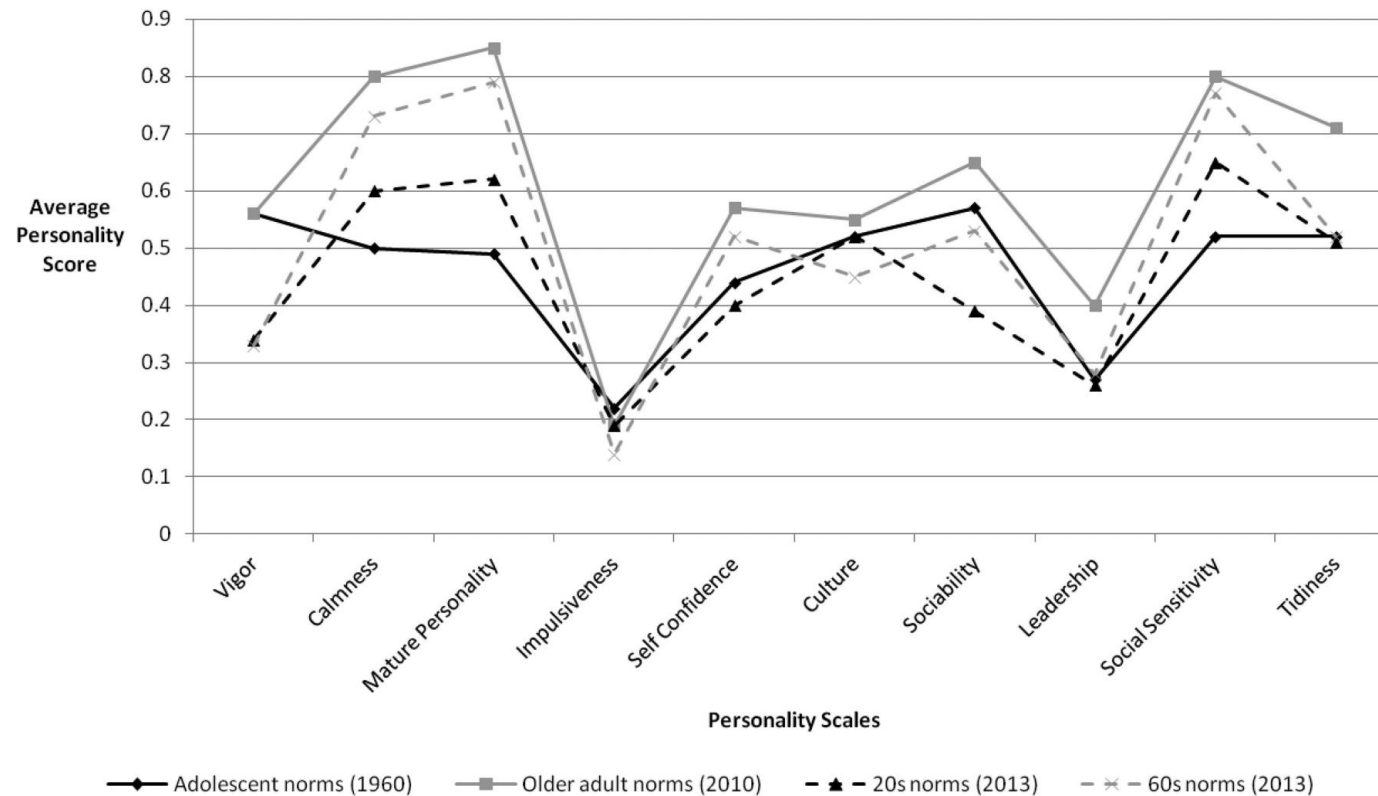




# Personality Changes Over Time



## Changes in personality across lifespan (MOST RECENT findings in 2019)

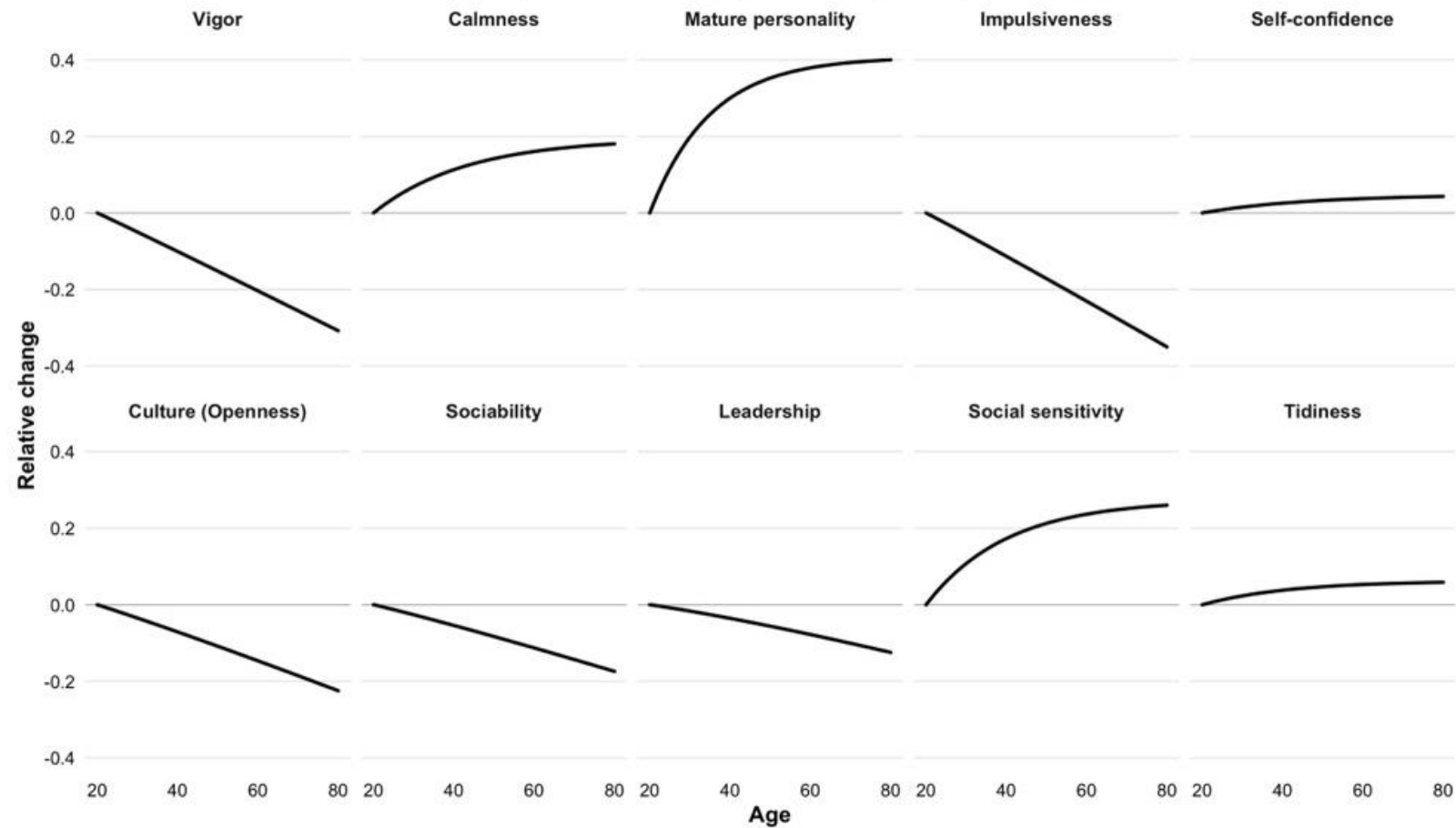


Damian et al. (2019)

# Personality Changes Over Time



## Changes in personality across lifespan (MOST RECENT findings in 2019)



Damian et al. (2019)



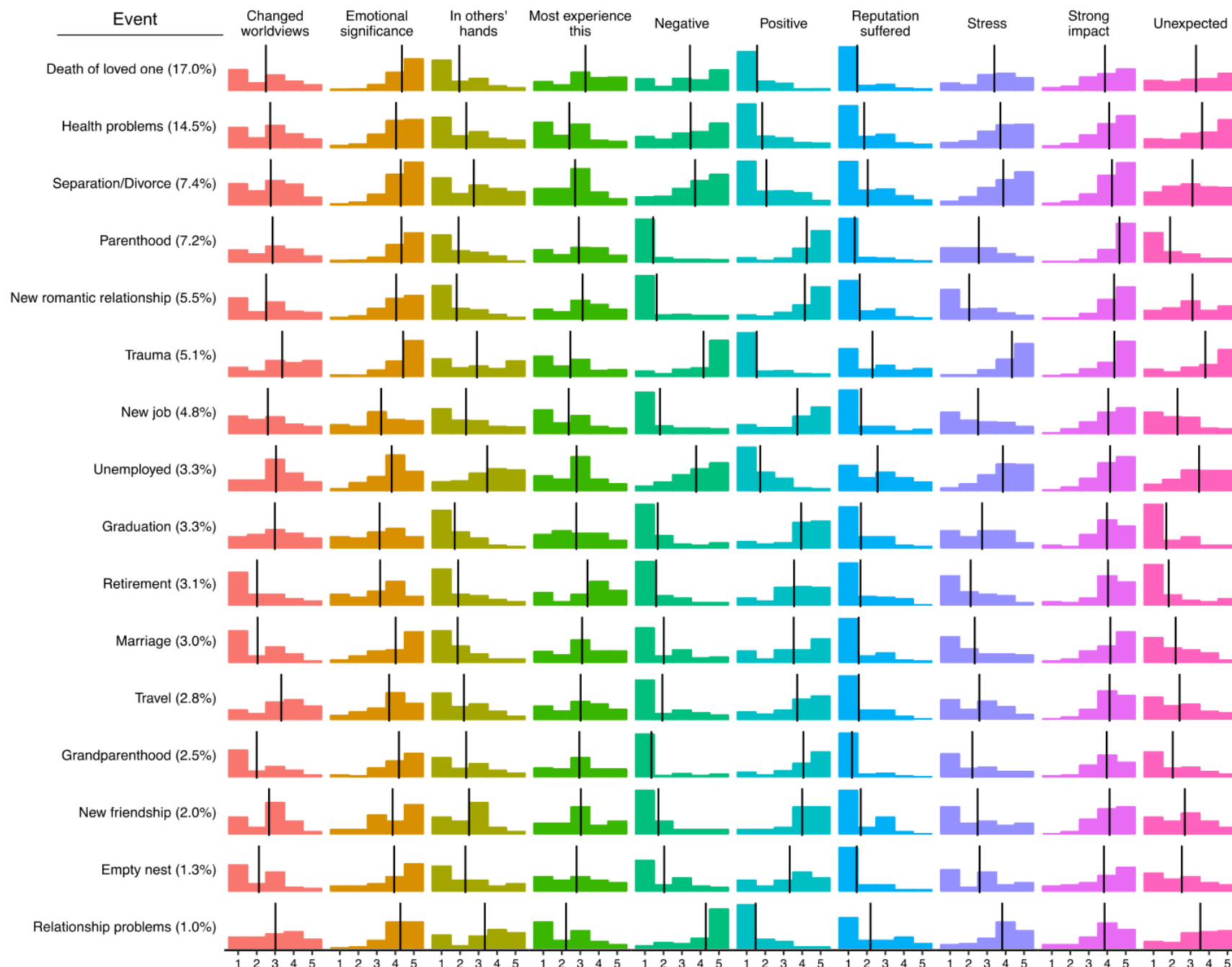
# What Changes Personality?

- Research shows 63% of people believe a life event changed their personality in the past 10 years
- Understanding how and why personality changes helps managers predict behaviors and adaptability in the workplace
  - **Life events:** graduation, marriage, divorce, job change
  - The same event can affect people differently based on how they perceive and respond to it

# What Changes

This event had an impact on my personality because...

(1: does not apply at all – 5: applies completely)



Schwaba1 et al. (2023)





# What Changes Personality?

- **Extraversion:** Can increase through social experiences or decrease after traumatic events
- **Agreeableness:** Often grows with relationship-building but may decline due to negative experiences
- **Conscientiousness:** Life responsibilities (e.g., parenthood, career shifts) tend to strengthen this trait; aging tends to lower this trait
- **Emotional stability:** Stressful events can cause fluctuations
- **Openness to experience:** Higher in young adulthood, but major life experiences can renew or reduce curiosity

# Personality and Behaviors



*Correlations Between Leisure Activities and Personality Traits*

| Activity                        | E                                                  | A                                                  | C                                                  | N                                                  | O                                                  |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Continuous activities           |                                                    |                                                    |                                                    |                                                    |                                                    |
| Exercise                        | <b>.12 [.10, .14], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | -.03 [-.05, -.01], $p = .004$                      | -.01 [-.03, .01], $p = .237$                       | <b>-.11 [-.13, -.09], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>.04 [.02, .06], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    |
| Voluntary work                  | .00 [-.02, .03], $p = .792$                        | .03 [.00, .05], $p = .037$                         | .02 [.00, .05], $p = .108$                         | <b>-.04 [-.07, -.02], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | .01 [-.01, .04], $p = .275$                        |
| Talking to close others         | <b>.20 [.18, .21], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>.24 [.22, .26], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | -.02 [-.04, -.01], $p = .011$                      | .03 [.01, .05], $p = .002$                         | <b>.18 [.17, .20], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    |
| Evening socializing             | <b>.27 [.25, .29], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>.06 [.04, .08], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>-.15 [-.17, -.13], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | -.02 [-.03, .00], $p = .060$                       | <b>.12 [.10, .14], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    |
| Chatting/MSN                    | .02 [-.01, .05], $p = .212$                        | -.04 [-.07, .00], $p = .036$                       | <b>-.18 [-.22, -.15], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>.09 [.05, .12], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | -.01 [-.04, .02], $p = .562$                       |
| Computer-mediated communication | <b>.09 [.07, .12], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | .03 [.01, .06], $p = .007$                         | <b>-.16 [-.18, -.13], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>.13 [.11, .15], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | .04 [.01, .06], $p = .003$                         |
| Active social media use         | <b>.08 [.05, .11], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | .00 [-.03, .03], $p = .997$                        | <b>-.12 [-.15, -.08], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>.09 [.06, .13], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | -.01 [-.04, .03], $p = .689$                       |
| Passive social media use        | <b>.07 [.05, .10], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>.05 [.02, .07], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>-.14 [-.16, -.11], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>.15 [.12, .17], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | .03 [.00, .05], $p = .033$                         |
| Online gaming                   | <b>-.09 [-.12, -.07], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>-.06 [-.09, -.04], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>-.12 [-.14, -.09], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>.05 [.02, .07], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | .01 [-.02, .03], $p = .548$                        |
| Watching TV/films               | <b>-.03 [-.05, -.02], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | -.02 [-.04, .00], $p = .014$                       | -.03 [-.04, -.01], $p = .002$                      | <b>.07 [.06, .09], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>-.16 [-.18, -.14], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> |
| Listening to music              | <b>.04 [.02, .06], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | .03 [.01, .05], $p = .001$                         | -.02 [-.04, .00], $p = .035$                       | .02 [.00, .03], $p = .096$                         | -.01 [-.03, .00], $p = .117$                       |
| Reading                         | -.02 [-.04, .00], $p = .017$                       | <b>.06 [.04, .08], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>.03 [.01, .05], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | -.02 [-.04, .00], $p = .035$                       | <b>.07 [.05, .09], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    |
| Cultural activities             | <b>.17 [.15, .19], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>.13 [.12, .15], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>-.04 [-.06, -.02], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>-.04 [-.05, -.02], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b> | <b>.31 [.29, .32], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    |
| Creative activities             | .00 [-.02, .03], $p = .779$                        | <b>.07 [.05, .09], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | -.02 [-.04, .00], $p = .042$                       | <b>.05 [.02, .07], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    | <b>.07 [.05, .09], <math>p &lt; .001</math></b>    |

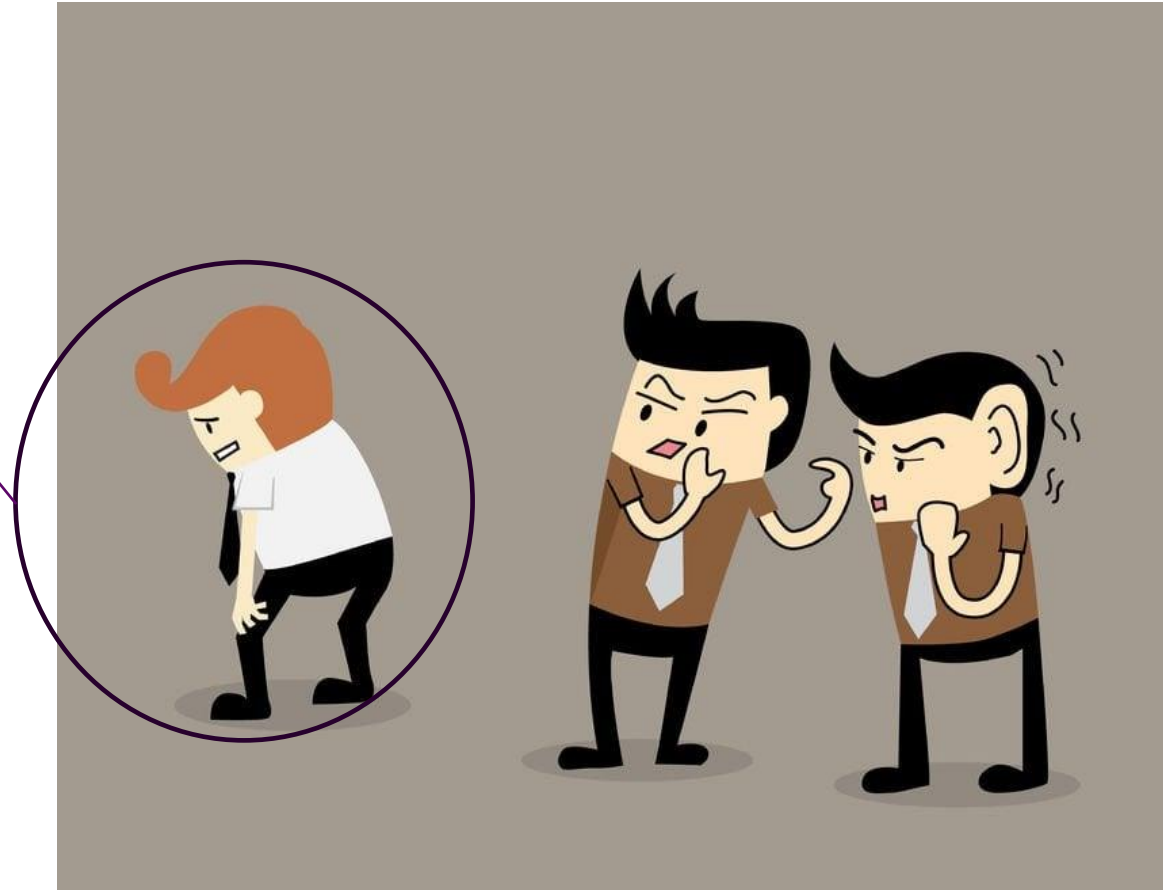
Kuper et al. (2022)

# Personality and Life

Who are likely to become targets of ostracism?

Individuals **low in conscientiousness or agreeableness** provoke more ostracism intentions and are more likely to be actually ostracized by others (Rudert et al., 2020 JPSP)

**Narcissism** is also a risk factor! (Buttner et al., 2025 JPSP)

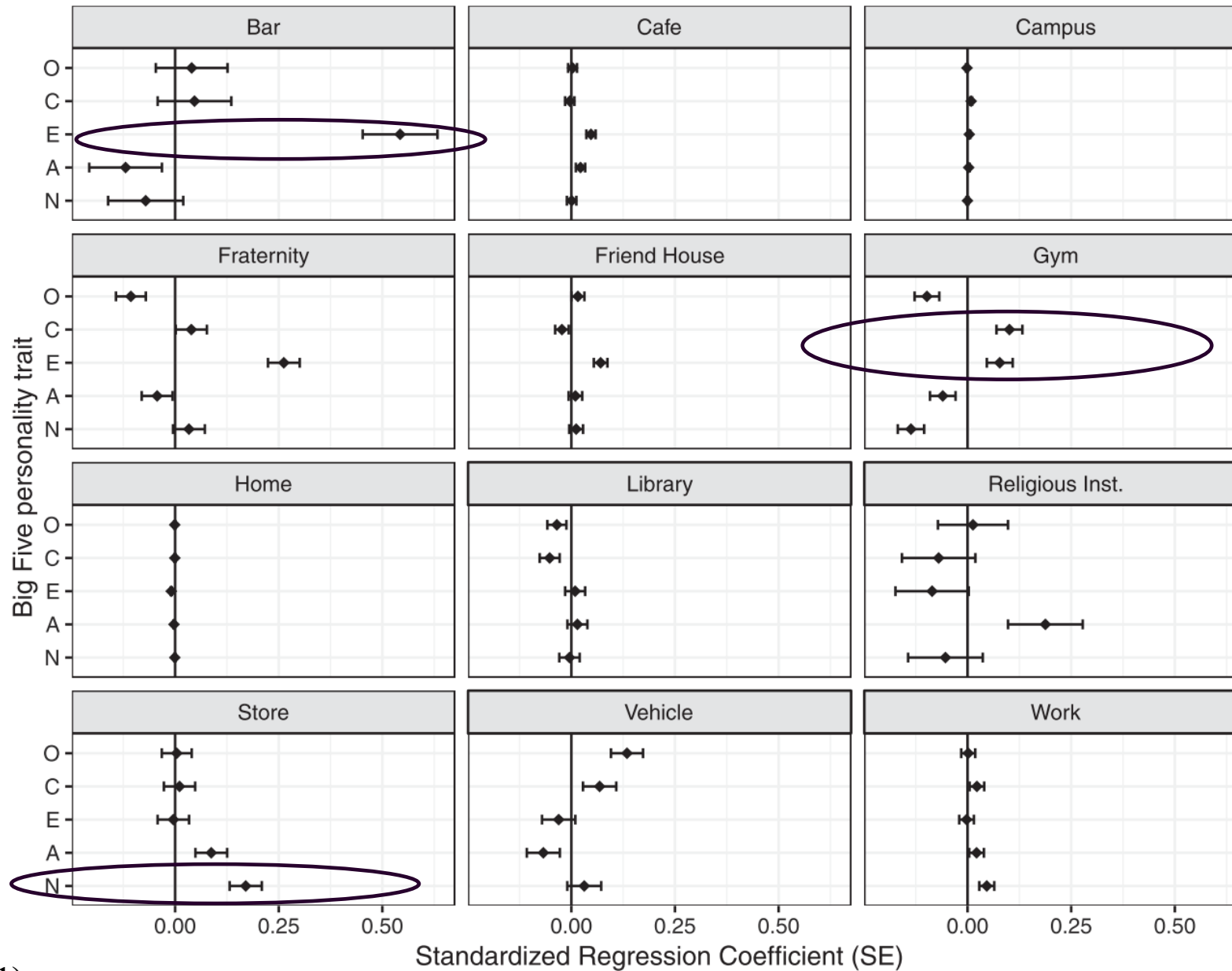




# Personality and Life







# Personality and Death (💀)

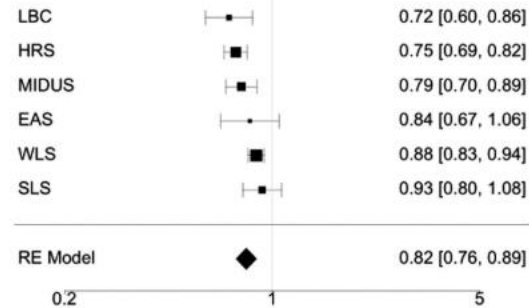
- Big Five personality trait consist
- Certain traits are associated with they affect decision-making and

Willroth et al. (2025) JPSP

Forest Plots Depicting Associations Between Personality Trait Level and Mortality Risk

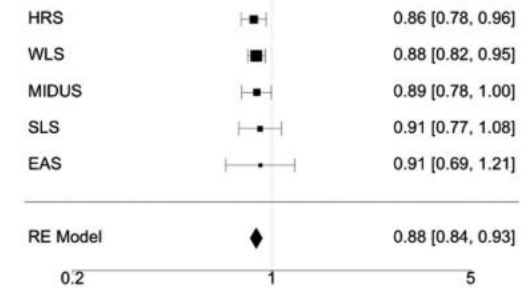
## Conscientiousness Level

( $Q = 13.54$ ,  $df = 5$ ,  $p = 0.02$ ;  $I^2 = 60.7\%$ )



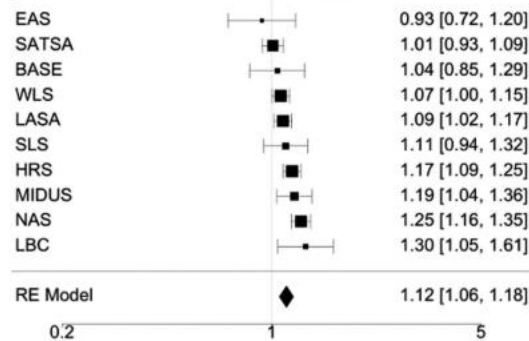
## Agreeableness Level

( $Q = 0.34$ ,  $df = 4$ ,  $p = 0.99$ ;  $I^2 = 0.0\%$ )



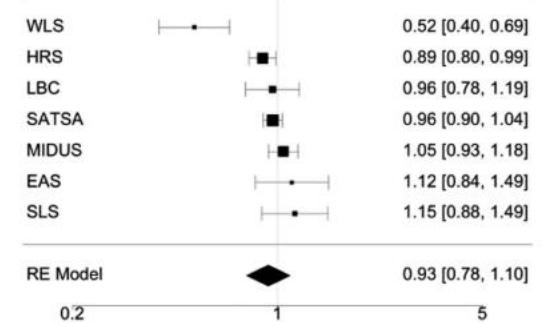
## Neuroticism Level

( $Q = 24.20$ ,  $df = 9$ ,  $p = 0.00$ ;  $I^2 = 62.3\%$ )



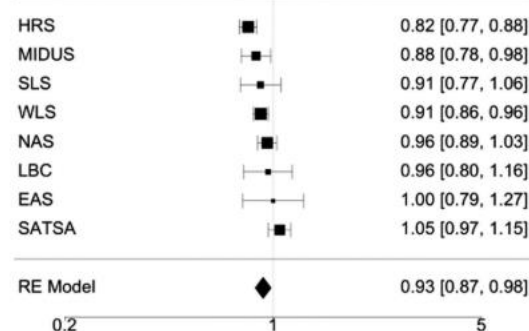
## Openness Level

( $Q = 25.67$ ,  $df = 6$ ,  $p = 0.00$ ;  $I^2 = 89.1\%$ )



## Extraversion Level

( $Q = 22.26$ ,  $df = 7$ ,  $p = 0.00$ ;  $I^2 = 68.0\%$ )

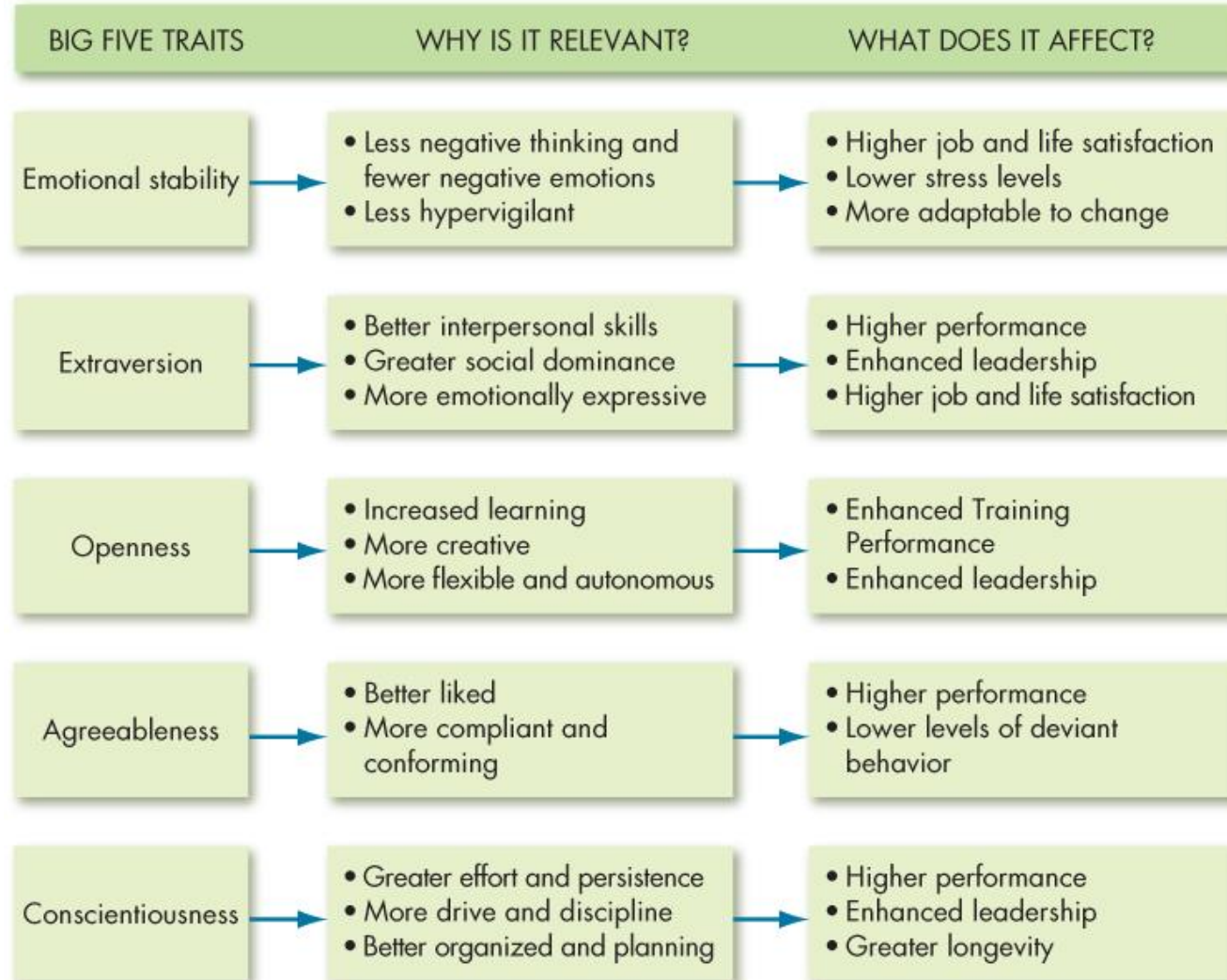


MIDUS = Midlife in the United States Study.  
 NAS = Normative Aging Study.  
 WLS = Wisconsin Longitudinal Study.  
 SATSA = Swedish Adoption/Twin Study of Aging.  
 SLS = Seattle Longitudinal Study.  
 HRS = Health and Retirement Study.  
 LASA = Longitudinal Aging Study Amsterdam.  
 LBC = Lothian Birth Cohort.  
 EAS = Einstein Aging Study.  
 BASE = Berlin Aging Study.

# Personality and Death (💀)

- Conscientiousness
  - More likely to engage in healthy behaviors; self-discipline
- Extraversion
  - Stronger social networks that provide emotional support
- Agreeableness
  - Lower stress levels and stronger support systems
-  Neuroticism
  - Higher stress levels and anxiety
  - Associated with increased risky behaviors such as substance use

# Personality and Workplace Behaviors





# Role of Situations

- Personality trait, values, and attitudes work simultaneously with *situations* to determine overall behaviors
- **Situation strength:** the degree to which situational constraints are present in the environment; whether the environment provides clear guidance for behavior
  - *Strong situation*
  - *Weak situation*



# Role of Situations

- **Trait activation:** trait activation is the process by which individuals express their traits when presented with trait-relevant situational cues
  - e.g., dealing with an angry customer

# Personality and Job Performance



## Predictors of Job Performance

|                          |                                      |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Extraversion</b>      | <b>Weak (<math>r=.06</math>)</b>     |
| <b>Conscientiousness</b> | <b>Moderate (<math>r=.14</math>)</b> |
| <b>Agreeableness</b>     | <b>Weak (<math>r=.07</math>)</b>     |
| <b>Neuroticism</b>       | <b>Weak (<math>r=-.09</math>)</b>    |
| <b>Openness</b>          | <b>Weak (<math>r=.04</math>)</b>     |

**But! It also depends on industry and occupation!**



# Personality and Job Performance



## Skilled

|   |                       |
|---|-----------------------|
| E | Weak ( $r=.04$ )      |
| C | Strong ( $r=.24$ )    |
| A | Weak ( $r=.08$ )      |
| N | Moderate ( $r=-.14$ ) |
| O | Weak ( $r=.03$ )      |

## Sales

|   |                      |
|---|----------------------|
| E | Moderate ( $r=.14$ ) |
| C | Strong ( $r=.27$ )   |
| A | Weak ( $r=.03$ )     |
| N | Weak ( $r=-.10$ )    |
| O | Weak ( $r=.03$ )     |

## Military

|   |                      |
|---|----------------------|
| E | Moderate ( $r=.13$ ) |
| C | Strong ( $r=.31$ )   |
| A | Weak ( $r=.10$ )     |
| N | Strong ( $r=-.25$ )  |
| O | Moderate ( $r=.16$ ) |

## Healthcare

|   |                      |
|---|----------------------|
| E | Moderate ( $r=.11$ ) |
| C | Strong ( $r=.33$ )   |
| A | Strong ( $r=.25$ )   |
| N | Weak ( $r=-.09$ )    |
| O | Weak ( $r=.02$ )     |

The relationship between personality and job performance varies across occupations

# Personality and Leadership



## Predictors of leader emergence

|                   |                       |
|-------------------|-----------------------|
| Extraversion      | Strong ( $r=.33$ )    |
| Conscientiousness | Strong ( $r=.33$ )    |
| Agreeableness     | Weak ( $r=.05$ )      |
| Neuroticism       | Moderate ( $r=-.24$ ) |
| Openness          | Moderate ( $r=.24$ )  |

## Predictors of leader effectiveness

|                   |                       |
|-------------------|-----------------------|
| Extraversion      | Moderate ( $r=.24$ )  |
| Conscientiousness | Moderate ( $r=.16$ )  |
| Agreeableness     | Moderate ( $r=.21$ )  |
| Neuroticism       | Moderate ( $r=-.22$ ) |
| Openness          | Moderate ( $r=.21$ )  |

Those who emerge and are effective as leaders are more likely conscientious, emotionally stable, open-minded extraverts